



LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

6875/01

Paper 1 (Set Texts: Closed Books)

For examination from 2027

SPECIMEN

Total marks: 60

Confidential

MARK SCHEME

General Descriptions

The general descriptions are an attempt to guide Examiners to an understanding of the qualities normally expected of, or 'typical' of work in the band. They must not be interpreted as hurdle statements, and form a means of general guidance. Photostats taken from work produced in the examination will be the principal means by which we shall standardise the marking.

A Descriptors for essays/passage-based tasks.

0 – 1	The answer does not meet the criteria for a mark in the next band.
2 – 3	Candidates will – Show a little awareness of... Make some comment about...
4 – 5	Candidates will – Make straightforward points about... Show a few signs of understanding... Make a little reference to aspects of the text... Make a simple personal response to...
6 – 8	Candidates will – Make some relevant comment about... Show some understanding of... With a little support from the text/reference to language.
9 – 11	Candidates will – Begin to develop a response... Show understanding of... With some detail from the text/reference to language. Begin to demonstrate an awareness of how the writer uses language.
12 – 14	Candidates will – Make a reasonably sustainably/extended response... Show understanding of... Show some thoroughness in the use of text for support. Make some responses to the way language works.
15 – 17	Candidates will – Make a convincing response... Show clear, sustained understanding of... Make careful and relevant reference to the text. Respond with some thoroughness/detail to the way language works.
18 – 20	Candidates will – Sustain a perceptive, convincing response... Demonstrate clear critical/analytical understanding Show some originality of thought. Make much well-selected reference to the text. Respond sensitively and in detail to the way language works. Responses will be deeply rooted in the text. The very best will achieve all the above, with flair, imagination and sophistication in addition.

B Band descriptors for Empathic Questions (imaginative/creative tasks)

There are three key elements to be looked for in responses to these questions:

- Sound knowledge of what happens in the text
- An understanding/interpretation of this
- The use of an authentic voice or voices

It is possible that some candidates will shy away from assuming the voice and phrasing of some tasks, particularly those referring to the character's thoughts, may perforce allow this. Responses of this sort can sometimes show insight despite not entering fully into the imaginative challenge. They should be assessed on the strength of that insight rather than the band descriptors below.

0 – 1	The answer does not meet the criteria for a mark in the next band.
0 – 2	Candidates will show a little knowledge of what the character does.
4 – 5	Candidates will show some knowledge of what the character does and express some view about the reasons for action
6 – 8	Candidates will show some understanding of character through aspects of the text referred to. There will be little mention of feelings and ideas.
9 – 11	Candidates will show a basic understanding of what the character does and thinks. These ideas will show little evidence of being expressed in an appropriate way.
12 – 14	Candidates will have a sound working knowledge on which to base their writing, which will have features of expression which are suitable and appropriate to the character or occasion.
15 – 17	Candidates will have a good knowledge and understanding and be able to use this to produce writing expressed in a way that is largely fitting and authentic. The character will be clearly recognisable through the voice assumed.
18 – 20	Candidates will use a full and assured understanding of the text to write in a manner that expressed the thoughts, feelings and attitudes of the character with assurance and insight. The voice assumed will be entirely appropriate for the character.

Marking Notes

In this syllabus, we aim at encouraging candidates to make some personal response to their reading. This means that, while we may have legitimate expectations as to the ground most answers may occupy, we must at all times be prepared to meet the candidates on their chosen ground. It is to be hoped that candidates will on occasion see other possibilities. In this exam, rigid demands for what must be in a good answer must be guarded against. The Photostat scripts circulated during coordination will be crucial to maintain the standard throughout the marking.

We must try at all times to tease out what that candidate is trying to say to us. It is possible for a candidate whose technical command of English is limited, but whose language still manages to communicate understanding to receive high marks. High marks should not be awarded for fluency and display of knowledge of literary terms if we feel there is little evidence of understanding. Remember that we are assessing literary responses, not language skills.

The notes that follow on the questions are for general guidance only, and are not rigid prescriptions of required content. They need to be used in connection with the generic band descriptors.

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and students, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of discussions that take place at an Examiner's meeting before marking begins.

All Examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated.

SECTION A: DRAMA

Answer **one** question from this section

J.B. PRIESTLY: *An Inspector Calls***1. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.**

More evident in this question is the Inspector's moral firmness in the very beginning when he is offered a glass of port or a little whisky by Mr Birling, he denies it as he is on duty. His self-discipline and control heighten his focus on his investigation of Eva Smith's death. He does not waver from his purpose, even when Birling tries to overpower him by flaunting his council seat and his relations with prestigious individuals, instead, he clearly states his mission. His cool but stern nature is reflected in his questions that display his intelligence and wisdom, with his impressive facts to dig the truth out of the Birlings. By refusing to let Gerald and Eric see the photograph and maintaining his cool while doing so, he displays firmness in the way he does things. Better responses will show how the powerful, omniscient nature of the Inspector add to his firmness and purposefulness.

2. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Even though Mr. Birling appears not to have learnt any lesson in the text he has however learnt to admit when wrong as evidenced by his offer to 'give thousands' to pay Eva Smith. He has also learnt to be firm with Eric. Mrs. Birling has learnt that she must not be overprotective of Eric. In addition, she learns not to be judgmental of others as she pronounces heavy punishment on the man or culprit who impregnated Eva not knowing that it is her son. Sheila learns to accept her wrongs as she displays remorse for getting Eva Smith fired from Milwards. She also learns to treat people well regardless of their status in society. Sheila learns that Gerald cannot be trusted. She moreover, learns that her parents are not saints after all. Lastly, Eric learns that responsible behavior is important as he admits that he was heavily drunk when he slept with Eva. Further, he learns to accept guilt when wrong. Better responses will show that both Sheila and Eric learn to stand up to their father's threats.

3. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Candidates will capture the appropriate voice of guilt and frustration by Gerald when he finally has to admit not only his knowledge of Eva Smith, but his intimate engagement with her. Gerald at this moment will be worried that his confession is laid bare before Sheila, and that his secret of cheating has come out. He will be afraid that Sheila may break off the engagement. In addition, Gerald may feel embarrassed that his near perfect character has been tarnished in the Birling family. He will also be worried about his own family and how they would react upon hearing such news. He will recall all the times he spent with Eva and feel guilty for using her much against Eva's true feelings of love and hope. Better responses will echo Gerald's voice of frustration, disappointment and worry resulting from the intense interrogation by the Inspector.

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE: *Twelfth Night***4. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.**

The characters of Olivia, Feste and Malvolio are revealed not only in what they say, but also in what they do. Olivia appears to be commanding in her attempt to dismiss Feste. Her good listening skills and reasoning are evident when she gives herself time to digest Feste's point of view on her endless mourning. This, however, also displays her pure love and attachment to her dead brother. She is positive-minded as she believes her brother to be in heaven. In this belief, her optimism is admired. She rebukes Malvolio for being selfish and getting things out of proportion when he provokes Feste. Even though a trusted adviser, Malvolio appears to be full of negative criticism. Though Feste plays on words and sometimes shows being dishonest and irritating, he encourages Olivia to stop mourning and focus on the positive that her brother is resting in heaven. In this, he reveals his consideration and kindness as Olivia indeed feels better. Better responses will engage with the writing to capture the appropriate character traits.

5. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Worth noting is the fact that this play offers a temporary escape from reality and is full of impossibilities. For example, grown adults are seen behaving like unruly children: Feste, being a clown, is allowed to make fun of everyone, regardless of their social positions. He dresses up as Sir Topas, a priest, and pretends to examine Malvolio, declaring him definitely insane. Sir Toby thinks better of the joke as he allows Malvolio to send a letter to Olivia. It seems unlikely that Viola could disguise herself so successfully as a man, that she and her brother could be mistaken for each other and cause confusion. The one apparently serious and responsible person, Malvolio, is actually a hypocrite, has an appalling trick played upon him and is rejected by almost every other character. The world turned upside down is reflected in the reversal of social order and class dynamics as characters such as Maria who belong to the low social class engage in scheming and deception with characters from the upper class. Better responses will find a lot of material to use in showing the strange world of this play.

6. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

As the person who came up with the plan to fool Malvolio, Maria is overly happy that she has finally had her revenge on the puritan. Maria marvels at how completely Malvolio has fallen for her trick and how foolish he behaved before Olivia. Do expect that Maria will feel a twinge of regret and pity for involving Olivia in her revenge mission. However, this is likely to be overshadowed by the success of her plan. Maria cannot wait to meet Sir Toby and Sir Andrew to gloat about Malvolio's humiliating experience and remind them that she did tell them that her plan would work. Good responses will show that even though Maria is excited, she is determined to put up a straight face in order to conceal the truth from Malvolio. She wants her plan to be carried out to the very end where Malvolio will be bound and taken to the dark room.

LORRAINE HANSBERRY: *A Raisin in the Sun*

7. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Candidates could pick from the opening line that Walter and Ruth have a loveless relationship. The way they converse shows that their relationship is disconnected and tense. Ruth's response to Walter's question about the check shows that there is resentment or bitterness in their relationship. Furthermore, Ruth asks Walter the kind of eggs he wants but after Walter has said, 'not scrambled eggs' she does the exact opposite preparing scrambled eggs which reveals a disrespectful relationship. Further, Walter tries to ease the tension by engaging Ruth on issues of national interest but Ruth's response shows an indifferent relationship. Further still, the way Walter repeatedly asks Ruth, 'What's the matter with you this morning?' reveals that their relationship lacks communication. Moreover, Walter continues to try and break the ice but Ruth's reaction reveals a toxic relationship. Walter again observes that Ruth is not interested in things he likes which clearly shows that there is disconnection in the relationship. The fact that Walter cracks a joke that Ruth doesn't receive well depicts a relationship that is damaged or flawed. Better responses are likely to notice that Ruth's monotonous and brusque responses heighten the tension between the two and revealing a relationship that is on the brink of collapsing.

8. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Candidates are invited to explore the extent to which one would sympathise with Walter. Responses should show an attempt to deal with both sides of the argument. Some of the reasons for feeling sympathy for Walter have to do with his disadvantaged background. Walter is an African American with racism and oppression rife in America. He is therefore a victim of circumstances far beyond his control. When Walter quietly refuses the white citizens' payoff at the end of the play, he wins our sympathy, and it absolves him from all his 'sins'. The reasons for the lack of sympathy will definitely be overwhelming. Firstly, there will be the condemnation that a man of his age still lives in his mother's house with his wife and son. Further condemnation will emanate from the fact that Walter drinks and smokes. He will be also condemned for his obsession with his father's life insurance money which he inexplicably loses to a deal gone sour. He gives the money to his friends Bobo and Willy. The latter runs away with the money. There are many other possibilities to consider for either side but better responses will point out that Walter at the end emerges as the new patriarch of the Younger family. By turning his life and priorities around in the end, he may win the sympathy of candidates who may forgive his past errors.

9. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

At this point Mama is absolutely gutted by Walter's lack of good judgment. In the face of the loss, Mama is likely to think that her dream of buying a house has dried up like a raisin in the sun. Her disappointment turns into rage and regret for giving the money to Walter, especially because it was meant to cater for Beneatha's medical school tuition. Mama at this moment is likely to agonise over how she has failed her husband who worked himself to death in order to provide his family with a nice home by giving part of the insurance money to Walter. She may recall how she was against Walter's idea to invest the money in a liquor business. Mama will likely pray to God to give her strength to deal with this crisis and to still be able to keep her family together. Better responses will also be in a recognisable and appropriate voice.

SECTION B: POETRY

Answer **one** question from this section

JACK HYDES, (ed.): *Touched with Fire: Section B 'The light of setting suns'*

10. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

The poet uses words to make the poem emotional by first describing the circumstances the porpoises find themselves in. He uses words such as 'abandoned', 'beached', 'squealing' and 'darkness' to show that the porpoises are trapped after heading to the shore. The poet calls their act 'suicide'. This elicits sadness. The description of the porpoises as they lay on the shore also makes us to pity them. 'Here they lay, bleeding, overheating...' The fact that the free porpoises swam towards the lost 'till they in turn were stranded' heightens the sadness and pity in the poem. This is insinuated by the endless use of commas to bring out the effect of the ongoing lamentation. Also, the use of commas creates a rhythmic effect that depicts the continuous suffering of the porpoises. The arrival of men on the scene with heavy knives (cleavers) creates horror as the use of cleavers shows that the men are vicious and without sympathy. The use of the simile to describe the porpoises as 'harmless as young children' gives the impression that they are very gentle and caring creatures. In essence, the porpoises pose no threat to man but were killed for food. However, the way the poet explains it makes us understand why the porpoises were killed, 'life was hard'. This evokes pity not only for the porpoises but for mankind as well. Better responses will point out that the speaker tries to amend his guilt by releasing the porpoises back to sea thus provoking feelings of happiness.

11. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

This is a somewhat open question and candidates should be allowed to express their views as long as they do not digress from the poem. *The Fallen Birdman* is a poem that deals with the tragic death of an old man who is crippled and confined to a wheelchair. Amongst many life issues, candidates are expected to note that the poem helps us understand that sometimes calamities in life happen at the same time. The poet describes how old age obviously comes with its own suffering and miseries. The personification of the rain heightens the effect of the gruesomeness of his death. The old man whose life has been nothing but wretched dies a terrifying death. This effect is heightened by the use of the simile on the very last line of the poem, explaining the hopelessness of the situation the victim is in. To prove how jinxed his life was, even the onlookers appear unsympathetic as they gaze at his mangled body. This highlights a lesson that people may be unsympathetic of one's misfortunes. Better responses will point out that even in death the old man is unfortunate as the reckless lorry driver accuses him of being responsible for his own death, '...it was his own fault' which is inconsiderate because this man was not only crippled but he was also blind as echoed by the words 'canvas' and 'cane'. They will also echo how the poet has helped us to understand that at times misfortunes follow people to their graves.

12. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

In *Nursery Rhyme of Innocence and Experience*, the passage of time is reflected through the young boy who asks if the captain of the ship will bring him gifts if he gives him 'my penny And my apricot tree'. At this moment, the boy is young and innocent. He seems to believe in fairy tales. This is reinforced by his description of the sailor's kiss, 'As strong as death' and the setting, 'the ship dipped down...'. After a long time, 'three long summers' the boy has grown up. His fairy tale perception of the ship has been altered by his growth and loss of childhood innocence. The ship's return is described factually as, 'a grey ship Come in from sea...'. The boy's description of the ship is of a ramshackle, 'her flashing rigging Was shot away...The sea birds cried and flew in and out of her hole in her side'. Instead of being met by the captain the boy spoke to, he is met by a stranger and this signifies the alterations that accompany the passage of time. Better responses may note that the theme of the passage of time is aptly depicted by the last stanza where the 'boy' complains, 'you brought me children's toys?' The incredulity conveyed in the boy's question succinctly shows that time has passed and he cannot even appreciate the gifts he had asked for three summers earlier.

BRIAN WALTER AND FELICITY WOOD (eds.): *Groundwork: An Introduction to Reading and Writing about Poetry*

13. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

The kettle metaphorically represents the cosy atmosphere of the background which evokes a happy feeling. The housewife is content with her effort of brightening up the place and she feels people will envy her and this makes us to admire the woman for being in a fulfilling marriage. The hyperbole, 'abloom' of the visiting lady presents her as a flower – she is being animated and depicted as very beautiful which makes the reader to be envious of the beautiful lady. She ironically exclaims that she has never seen 'so sweet a room' which provokes anger as the woman is pretentious. However, the secret lurks around the peaceful teatime. The young wife does not know that the visiting lady was her husband's first choice and this makes to pity this naïve young bride. Line 9: 'till the fates ordained it could be so...', shows that the husband and the guest were separated by circumstances beyond their control and thus deserve a bit of sympathy. Better responses will bring out the different emotions that arise from this love triangle. The hypocritical smile of the lady and the deceitful behaviour of the husband evoke anger. He secretly and desirously flirts with his former lover in the presence of his oblivious wife which makes us pity her while detesting the husband.

14. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

In the poem *Roddy M'Corley*, Roddy M'Corley is awaiting a horrifying death by public execution. Being very young, one expects a reflection of his fright, instead, he is ready to face death courageously and hides his fear. He is not going to break before his prosecutors as dying for liberation is his will. The metaphoric use of 'there's never a tear in his blue eyes' denotes his lack of fear and his innocence as he is dying for a worthy cause, something very admirable. He views death as something to succumb to and not to fear or worry about as it is inevitable. His bravery in facing his execution is heroic as he walks with pride, smiling to his death. He is only celebrating his victory and the cheering of the crowd boosts his courage and heroism. The use of the repetition 'On the Bridge of Toome today' emphasizes Roddy's pomp despite his impending execution. Better responses will engage with the writing to bring out not only the positive attitude of the poet towards death but also their own personal feelings towards the persona's bravery and heroism.

15. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at our mark.

In *Poem for my Mother*, the mother's harsh labour intensifies her life, making it difficult for her to understand and grasp the words and feelings expressed by her loving daughter in the poem. The daughter's innocence and immaturity make it hard for her to understand the effects of her mother's experiences and position at the time. She, therefore, feels despair as her mother misses the effect of her emotions. Their different points of view are very distinct in their contrasts: 'Your hands' and 'my words'. Furthermore, the use of the metaphor 'the shrivelled burnt granadilla...' denotes the perpetual backbreaking labour the mother is subjected to. This suggests a gap between their worlds, as the mother is more practical while her daughter's innocence makes her more intellectual. The daughter's sadness and hurt are conveyed as her mother disregards her poem. The use of the simile 'slid like a ball' explains the mother's failure to understand the significance of her daughter's gesture. Her disappointment, deflation and dismay are evident in her words. The subject suggests that this should be a loving and tender relationship but it is ruined by lack of understanding, as the daughter fails to see through the damages caused by social factors in her mother by being immature. Better responses will engage with the writing to illustrate how time and maturity has an effect on relationships.

ELISE VARGA (ed.): *Unbroken Chains: An Anthology of Poetry*

16. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

This poem is about how friendships and relationships change over time. The effects of the change, no doubt, evokes a variety of emotions in which candidates should be met at their chosen ground. The sadness and devastation brought about by the loss of friendship also leave one lonely as you cannot spend time together anymore, but all your time has been wasted. The end of love brings pain and suffering as one is left with a void that will never be filled up by anyone. The sudden vanishing of dreams and hopes makes one to be bitter and regret the lost opportunities. The repetitive use of the phrase, 'a fountain empties itself', emphasises how relationships or friendships completely disappear leaving one heartbroken. Better responses may acknowledge that such devastating loss leaves one emotionally drained and thus every opportunity that avails itself must be used wisely.

17. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

The subject of beauty is admired by the poet in the sense that he feels beauty should be maintained. He argues that the beauty of the youth must be preserved through procreation, and this should be done quickly as time passes on and one gets older. The second quatrain mentions that the youth is concerned with only his beauty, 'thine own bright eyes' and 'Feed'st thy light's flame with self-substantial fuel', a metaphor explaining that he feeds his light with his own loveliness. Thus, the youth should produce heirs to continue his beauty and this should be done in the given time. Better responses will highlight that the poet warns the youth that if he does not reproduce, he will be viewed as greedy with his beauty and that time should permit him to bring forth a child so that his beauty does not die. This is echoed by the dominant use of metaphors throughout the poem.

18. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

In the poem, *In Detention*, the poet portrays a very difficult life situation where many innocent people die under unclear circumstances. This satire exposes the behavior of police brutality towards prisoners. More nerve-wrecking and disappointing are the innocent souls dying at the hands that should provide safety and security for them. Prison thus is viewed as a place of torture and death. By not mentioning their names, it is clear that they are stripping each victim of their identity. Repetition is extremely used to attack and expose the absurd and senseless explanations or reasons for the deaths. It is very ridiculous that each statement becomes increasingly strange: 'He fell from the ninth floor', 'He hanged himself', 'He slipped on a piece of soap while washing', nothing but distorting facts. Shocking enough is that the policemen expect the public to believe such obvious lies. Better responses will highlight the irony and disappointment the public is exposed to by the law enforcers.

SECTION C: PROSE

Answer **one** question from this section.

HARPER LEE: *To Kill a Mockingbird*

19. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Candidates should specify why the discussion between Scout and Miss Maudie is serious and in some instances amusing. The fact that Scout enquires from Miss Maudie if, 'Boo Radley's still alive?' simply shows that this is a serious concern by Scout which she feels must be clarified in order to put the matter to rest. That Scout's mind is in growing turmoil pertaining to the status of Boo Radley is clearly demonstrated when she ignores Miss Maudie's comment about her flowers. Scout persists with the question on Boo, 'How do you know?' Her persistence reveals how serious the issue is to her. Candidates may find it amusing that Scout supposes that Boo died and, '...they stuffed him up the chimney.' This is a ridiculous childish thought which surely provokes laughter. It must be amusing that Miss Maudie compares Jem to Jack Finch who is known to be fond of alcohol and an antitheses of Atticus. Moreover, the way in which Scout describes how Jack sent marriage proposals to Miss Maudie is quite amusing as he, 'yelled across the street for Miss Maudie to come marry him'. Better responses will realize that even though Miss Maudie speaks of the foot washing Baptists (fanatical) in an amusing manner this is a very serious discussion as it addresses the prejudice that exists in Christendom, especially against women.

20. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Candidates are expected to consider the extent to which Boo Radley is a character that deserves our pity. Responses should show an attempt to deal with both sides of the argument. Boo is mistreated by his father, who kept him under lock and key for a youthful misdemeanour. Candidates must realise that what makes Boo's predicament pitiful is that the boys he was with when they committed the felony attended industrial school and received the best secondary education to be had in the state while Boo is locked away for the rest of his life. Boo Radley is a lonely man who attempts to reach out to Jem and Scout for love and friendship, such as leaving them small gifts and figures in a tree knothole. Candidates may also pity Boo for being regarded as evil, something like a ghost or a monster. Stories that he walked around in the dark and harmed things abound. Better responses will note that later on towards the end of the story, Boo Radley wins our admiration when he saves the lives of Jem and Scout when they are viciously attacked by Bob Ewell. Boo's act of carrying the unconscious Jem back into the Finch's house shows that he is genuinely kind and protective of the children.

21. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Jem at this point is relieved to be back in the safety of his bedroom but remorseful about their act of going to the Radley house. He is obviously greatly relieved that in the morning he will be able to show Atticus his pants and thus avoid being whipped by him. Jem may also be wondering as to who had mended his pants, folded them and neatly placed them on the fence. Jem may perhaps think deeply about their decision to peep through the window of the Radley House. He may also rue listening to Dill as he ended up having to go back on his own to fetch his trousers. Jem is likely to remember with a shudder the roar of Mr. Nathan Radley's gun. The thought of the danger he had exposed his sister Scout to and the possibility of dying from the gun shot is likely to leave Jem numb with fear. Jem is likely to wonder if Scout had not betrayed him by telling Atticus the truth. However, the realization that Atticus was not up to meet him when he returned would convince him that Scout had not ratted on him. Better responses will capture Jem's pensive mood and regretful tone.

CHINUA ACHEBE: *Things Fall Apart*

22. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Some candidates may make no clear distinction between the horror and the sadness as these are intertwined. Candidates may note that the setting described in the passage brings out feelings of horror. Firstly, it is said, 'darkness was around the corner, and the burial was near.' The burial of a person on its own is a horrifying experience. The realisation that the burial will take place under the cover of darkness exacerbates the horror. The firing of guns, though meant to salute the fallen clansman, also adds to the horror. The cry of agony and shouts of horror that followed the gun salute intensified the horror. Candidates may note that the silence that followed was borne out of horror, as the crowd was shocked into silence. The sight of the boy lying in a pool of blood aggravates the horror. Most shockingly the boy is the son of the deceased. Feelings of horror are also brought about by the realisation that it is the village hero, Okonkwo's gun that had 'pierced the boy's heart'. The punishment to be meted to Okonkwo for the accidental shooting is eviction from his fatherland. This evokes sadness, especially the heart-wrenching spectacle of his wives and children weeping. The destruction of his *obi* evokes sadness as Okonkwo had invested heavily in its construction. Better responses are likely to notice that the killing of twins is a horrifying cultural practice and thus would feel sad for Obierika whose twins he had to throw away.

23. Refer to the Photostats and the band descriptors when arriving at your mark.

Candidates will find a lot of material upon which to base their responses for either side of the argument. Those who believe that Okonkwo is a hero may consider his feats of courage as a basis for their argument. As a young man of eighteen Okonkwo brought honor to his village by throwing Amalinze, the cat. Okonkwo never quits while he is still alive. He is a fierce fighter. He himself is surprised by his indefatigable spirit when he thought that, 'he did not sink under the load of despair.' Okonkwo was loyal to his family and his village. He went to war for his people and he is devoted to the Ibo culture. Candidates may recall that he is described as a 'man of action, a man of war...' Again, candidates who view Okonkwo as a villain to be despised will find plenty of material to support their stance. Okonkwo murders Ikemefuna after deceiving him. This he does much against the warning of Ogbuefi Ezeudu. Okonkwo shows villainous attributes when beating his wives and children. Furthermore, Okonkwo is very stubborn and kills a Christian messenger. He is short-tempered and 'had a slight stammer' thus if he could not get his point across, he used his fists. Some candidates will argue that Okonkwo is villainous for his hatred and intolerance for women and children.

24. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

At this moment Okonkwo is filled with an immense sense of relief and excitement. He spent the seven years in Mbanta with great regret. Though he is grateful to his uncle and his mother's clan for taking him and his family in, he cannot wait to be among his people. However, Okonkwo is likely to remember that he has lost his esteemed position among his clan. Also, he is likely to rue missing out on leading his warlike clan against the new religion that his friend Obierika has told him about. In addition, Okonkwo is bound to regret the lost years in which he might have taken the highest titles. He is also likely to think that with two beautiful grown-up daughters his return to Umofia will attract considerable attention. He will be quick though to vow to turn away poor and weak potential sons-in-law. Candidates may realise that even though Okonkwo left in shame he is filled with so much determination that 'his return should be marked by his people'. He, at this moment, will appreciate the role played by Obierika his friend, especially in rebuilding his compound and cultivating his fields for him. Better responses will note that Okonkwo is determined to rebuild his compound on a magnificent scale and take the highest titles in the land. Expect that candidates do come with other more relevant thoughts expressed in the appropriate voice.

BARRIE WADE (ed.): *Into the Wind: Contemporary Stories in English*

25. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Usually, there is a very thin margin between discontentment and unease, so expect that candidates may use them interchangeably in their response. The passage offers a lot of material for candidates to use in their response. At the very beginning it informs us that Horse is still discontented and uneasy. Even though he can hear the crows and speak a little bit of their language, the fact that he cannot freely engage with them and is still a horse is his biggest obstacle. Also nobody cares that he has learnt the language. The fact that they also allow him to be free did not mean he could be able to run away as they knew he would not get far. Moreover, he wanted to go but the impending winter prevented him. He is also made to sleep outside and is only glad that he is not a dog as Greasy Hand treated them cruelly. He is uneasy as he is afraid to get in their way as they only just tolerate him. Better responses might be expected to note that the killing of the dog heightened his uneasiness as he knew it could have been him. The fact that he never fitted into the Crows way of life shows fully the discontentment he feels.

26. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

Candidates will mostly find Lillian an admirable character as she refuses to succumb to the pressure of her family and community. She strikes out for the happiness she desires. For instance, she changed her skirt and shaped it well above her knees, wears large looping earrings, and has well-styled hair, in order to look and feel good regardless of what her mother and community expect of her. Thus, her courage is admirable, as she is bold and full of pomp. Though conscious of her behavior in the streets, so much pity arises from the stigma she carries of having divorced her first husband. Her mother's expectations to embrace her fiancée much against her will and being barred from enjoying her freedom of choice heightens our pity for her. More pitiful is when she is caught in a love triangle. She feels isolated and very sorry for herself. Better responses will acknowledge that Lillian had to suffer all the same even without doing any wrong, deserving our pity and of course admiration as she rises above her ordeal.

27. Refer to Photostats and the band descriptors in arriving at your mark.

At this moment Selina has undergone so much pain and trouble as an immigrant in a place she knows nobody. Her frustration and confusion about how to earn a living are the most prominent feelings as her experiences of emotional abuse by her landlord and landlady still haunt her. Mr. Sims comes as a relief and life-saver for immediately rescuing her as he offers her his empty flat, despite that they have just met. She is pleased to be harboured and appreciative at this moment for she had nowhere else to go in this strange land. Admirable in her character are her high self-esteem and courage to face any trouble that comes her way. Better responses are expected to capture her appropriate voice of determination and boldness.